

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 218 · HOT

Armada

Edge AI Infrastructure · Modular, Satellite-Connected Data Centres · San Francisco (founded late 2022) · Private (\$2B pre-money; \$230M Series B, May 2026)

Armada, the San Francisco builder of ruggedised, satellite-connected data centres that run on oil fields, mines and Navy sites, closed an oversubscribed \$230M Series B at a \$2B pre-money valuation on 19 May 2026 and will build them at a new Arizona factory with Johnson Controls from this summer.

75
OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

TGR Haas F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

On 19 May 2026 Armada announced a \$230M oversubscribed Series B at a \$2B pre-money valuation, co-led by Overmatch, BlackRock and 8090 Industries, taking total funding to nearly \$500M. Johnson Controls invested alongside an agreement to build Galleon Forge One, an up-to-400,000 sq ft Arizona factory with more than 500 jobs, in continuous production from summer 2026. The company says customer bookings grew 540% from FY25 to FY26. Its Galleon and Leviathan units are self-contained, Starlink-connected data centres for places with no grid or fibre: oil fields, mines, ships and bases.

The grid has already bought the data-centre archetype: Core Scientific joined Cadillac as official data-centre partner in March 2026, CoreWeave sits at Aston Martin, Hewlett Packard Enterprise at Mercedes. None of them sells compute that travels. A Formula 1 garage is a temporary remote site rebuilt 24 times a year, which is the problem Armada was founded to solve, and Microsoft's M12 and Johnson Controls are investor names a team can put on a car.

WHY NOW

The round closed on 19 May and Galleon Forge One starts production this summer, so the brand story and the budget crest together. The United States GP in Austin (October) and the Las Vegas GP (November) are the American stages left in 2026, and teams settle 2027 partner rosters in the fourth quarter.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$230M

\$230M oversubscribed Series B at a \$2B pre-money valuation, announced 19 May 2026 in a company release and...

540%

The company says customer bookings grew 540% from FY25 to FY26.

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

TGR Haas F1 Team ◆ RECOMMENDED	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
McLaren Mastercard F1 Team	TAKEN	Dell Technologies
Aston Martin Aramco F1 Team	TAKEN	NetApp
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A \$230M round at \$2B pre-money, a factory in production this summer and a product that is literally a data centre for remote sites give Armada budget, story and a real garage workstream at once. The compute lane at the American privateer is open and two US races remain inside the window.

WHY TGR HAAS F1 TEAM

Haas is the American-owned privateer of the grid, built by a machine-tool manufacturer, and its technology roster is connectivity and services: CommScope as Official Connectivity Partner, Ruckus Networks for trackside networking, Mphasis for digital services. No compute, cloud or data-centre partner is listed. Armada's units plug in behind the network Ruckus already runs, so the fit is complementary: two American industrial brands, one Arizona factory, Austin as the launch stage.

VALUE TO TGR HAAS F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. Each race weekend the team rebuilds a remote site: a garage of compute for telemetry, video and strategy, in a car park in Baku or a paddock in Las Vegas. A ruggedised Galleon in the freight, with Starlink backhaul managed by Armada's software, gives Haas a garage data centre that works before the circuit's fibre does, plus edge inference on the factory-to-track link. In return: Austin and Las Vegas hospitality for Armada's energy and government buyers.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Edge Computing Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, across the Arizona ramp and a probable listing window. Estimated \$2-4M a year, part-payable in equipment and managed services. Scope: sidepod or halo placement, a Galleon in the garage, US-race hospitality, engineering content built on the freight-to-pit-wall story.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Dan Wright

CO-FOUNDER & CEO, ARMADA · VERIFIED

Wright co-founded Armada in late 2022 after running DataRobot as CEO and AppDynamics as COO through its \$3.7B sale to Cisco; he fronts every raise and the Johnson Controls deal. Path: Jon Runyan, Co-Founder and COO, ex-Oktane general counsel. No chief marketing officer is listed.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the garage as a remote site.

“Dan, you build data centres for places with no fibre and no grid. A Formula 1 garage is that place 24 times a year, and the American privateer has no compute partner. 25 minutes before Austin to price a Galleon in the freight?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 17 / 20 Round closed 19 May; Arizona production from summer; Austin and Las Vegas in window.	CAPACITY 15 / 20 \$230M raise at \$2B pre-money; nearly \$500M raised; marketing budget still modest.	BRAND FIT 15 / 20 American-built AI infrastructure for hard places; industrial customer base.	URGENCY 12 / 20 Rivals hold data-centre lanes at three teams; no hard deadline beyond Q4 rosters.	OPS FIT 16 / 20 MODE A: a travelling garage data centre with satellite backhaul.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

SCALE OF SPEND A \$2B company with no marketing chief; a multi-million F1 fee competes with factory capital. **Counter:** Size the entry at the Haas price point; structure part of it as equipment and managed services.

NETWORK LANE OVERLAP Ruckus and CommScope hold connectivity at Haas; Armada manages Starlink terminals, which the team could read as the same lane. **Counter:** Define the category as edge compute and satellite backhaul, and clear it with Haas before the first call.

SOURCES — 16 OF 16 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://theorg.com/org/armada-2/org-chart/dan-wright
- https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/armada-announces-agreement-with-johnson-controls-for-galleon-forge-one-raises-230m-in-oversubscribed-series-b-with-a-pre-money-valuation-of-2b-to-accelerate-deployment-of-the-us-ai-stack-and-support-explosive-customer-demand--302775720.html
- https://www.cadillacf1team.com/partners